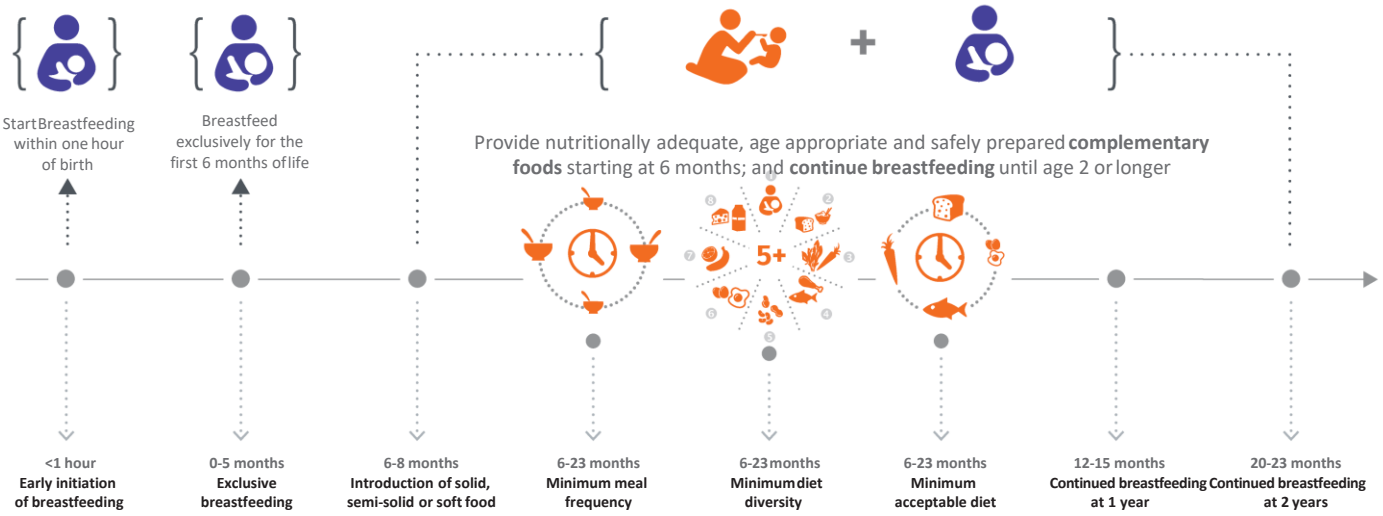
Bangladesh 2019

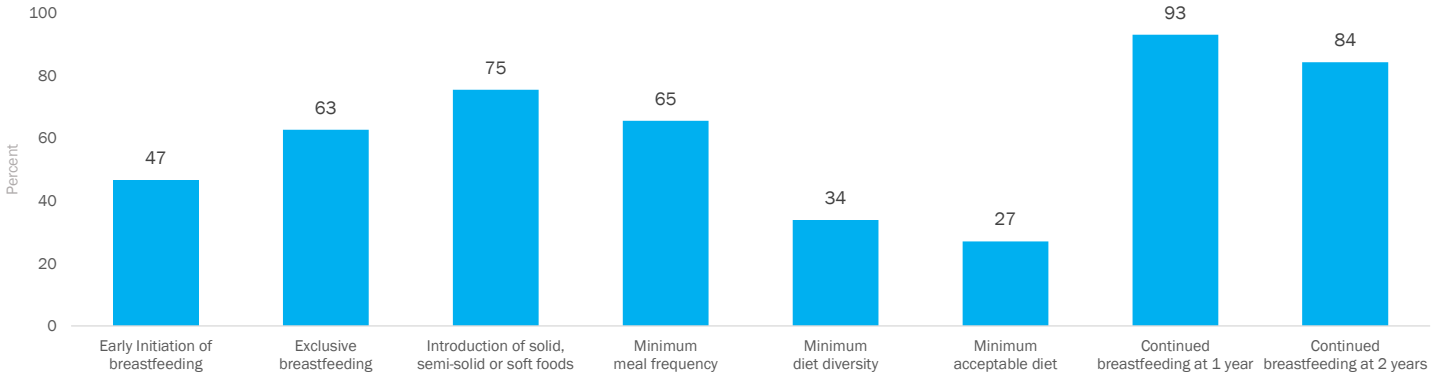
Infant & Young Child Feeding (IYCF)

Multiple Indicator Cluster Surveys

unicef

Infant & Young Child Feeding





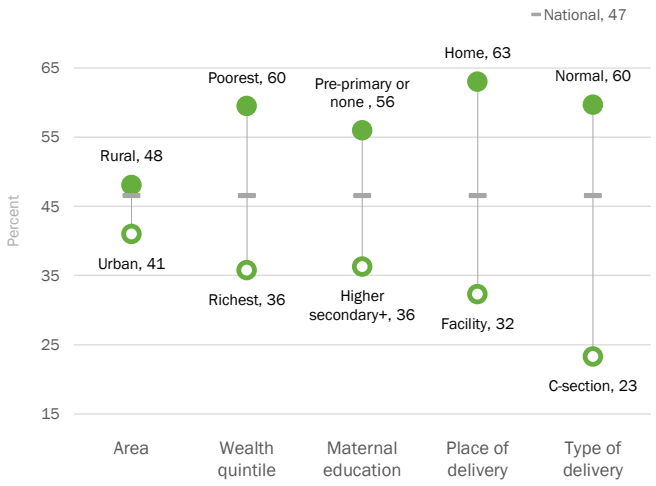
Early initiation: percentage of newborns put to breast within 1 hour of birth; **Exclusive breastfeeding:** percentage of infants aged 0-5months receiving only breastmilk; **Introduction to solids**: percentage of infants aged 6-8 months receiving solid or semi-solid food; **Minimum diet diversity:** percentage of children aged 6-23 months receiving 5 of the 8 recommended food groups; **Minimum meal frequency:** percentage of children aged 6-23 months receiving the recommended minimum number of solid/liquid feeds as per the age of child; **Minimum acceptable diet:** percentage of children aged 6-23 months receiving the minimum diversity of foods and minimum number of feeds; **Continued breastfeeding at 1 year:** percentage of children aged 12-15 months who continue to receive breastmilk**; Continued breastfeeding at 2 years:** percentage of children aged 20-23 months who continue to receive breastmilk.

Key Messages

- Findings from this MICS show low overall rates of early initiation of breastfeeding (47%). Richer women live in urban areas and have higher levels of education, and women who gave birth in health facilities and via caesarean section are substantially less likely to breastfeed within one hour of birth. There is a great need to improve awareness amongst women and health professionals in Bangladesh about the benefits of early initiation of breastfeeding.
- In Bangladesh, most women (93%) continue breastfeeding beyond a year, and 84% continue breastfeeding beyond two years, indicating that many children in Bangladesh experience the benefits of receiving breastmilk into their second year of life. However, only 65% of children aged 6-23 months receive the minimal meal frequency recommended for children this age. Even fewer children aged 6-23 months receive the recommended minimum diet diversity (34%) and a minimum acceptable diet (27%). These data indicate poor transition from breastfeeding to a healthy diet, which puts children at risk for stunting, wasting, and other illnesses caused by malnutrition.
- Children who live in a rural and poor households, whose mothers/caretakers have low levels of education and younger children are far less likely to receive the minimum recommended diet diversity. However, less than half the children who live in urban and wealthy households, whose mothers/caretakers attained higher secondary education and older children receive the minimum recommended diet diversity. These data indicate that poor nutrition for children in Bangladesh is not only a result of a lack of access to good food and economic constraints. Lack of knowledge regarding a healthy and diverse diet is evident even in urban, wealthy, and educated households. There is an urgent need to provide mothers, caretakers and health professionals knowledge about appropriate feeding of young children, including the consumption of appropriate, adequate and safe complementary foods after six months, which leads to better health and growth outcomes for children.

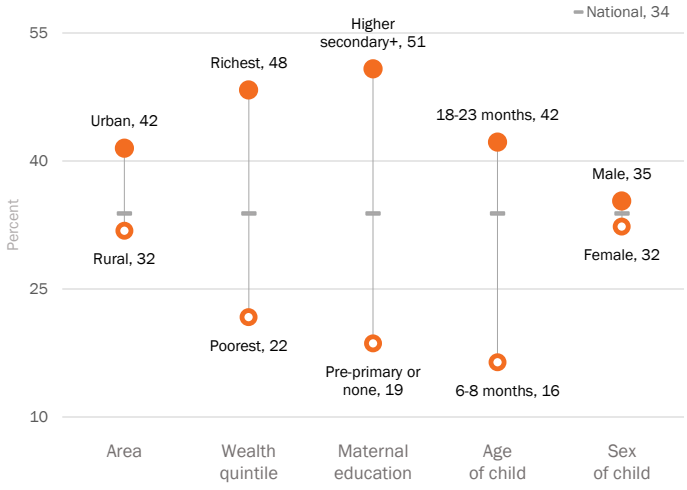
IYCF: Equity (lowest vs highest)

Early Initiation of Breastfeeding



Percent of newborns put to the breast within one hour of birth, by background characteristics

Minimum Diet Diversity



Percent of children aged 6-23 months that were fed food from at least 5 out of 8 food groups, by background characteristics

Newborn Breastfeeding and Dietary Diversity

Divisional Data

Division	Early Initiation of breastfeeding	Minimum Diet Diversity
National	**47**	**34**
Barishal	55	40
Chattogram	44	30
Dhaka	37	41
Khulna	38	41
Mymensingh	51	24
Rajshahi	43	30
Rangpur	56	34
Sylhet	75	24

Percent of newborns put to the breast within one hour of birth, and per cent of children aged 6-23 months that were fed food from at least 5 out of 8 food groups by geographic region

The Bangladesh Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey (MICS) was carried out in 2019 by the Bangladesh Bureau of Statistics as part of the global MICS programme. Technical and financial support was also provided by the United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF).

The objective of this snapshot is to disseminate selected findings from the Bangladesh MICS 2019 related to Infant & Young Child Feeding (IYCF). Data from this snapshot can be found in tables TC.7.1, TC.7.2, TC.7.3, TC.7.5, TC.7.6, TC.7.7.

Further statistical snapshots and the Survey Findings Report for this and other surveys are available on mics.unicef.org/surveys.